

The Thinkmaker

Because the chairman of the \$4.5 billion IT behemoth wrote a bestselling book of ideas, *Imagining India*, and has become an articulate catalyst of change, who's embedded in top government councils at home and in influential economic forums globally, representing the voice of India.

Because he's the only Indian on the foundation board of the World Economic Forum, is a member of the prestigious Petersen Institute of International Economics, and was again the solitary Indian to have spoken at the invitation-only Technology Entertainment and Design (TED) in California.

Because he's welcomed not just on the prime minister's council at the Centre but on numerous committees of a rival state government.

awkward moment Wife Rohini insists on asking questions when he is delivering a lecture in public.

proud moment When wife Rohini set up the Arghyam Foundation with a corpus of Rs 150 crore to focus on water management.

Truth Mascot

Because he's the last word on objectivity, whether it's the Hyderabad Metro project or the airport modernisation in Delhi and Mumbai.

Because he has made the Capital appear a world-class metropolis, making the Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) the most punctual metro transport in the world, with 99.5 per cent punctuality last year.

Because DMRC has helped save over 700 lives till date by avoiding road accidents, has reduced consumption of petrol, diesel and cng by 1,19,025 tonnes and saved 66 minutes every day per commuter.

strange, but true Hasn't taken a vacation in 20 years. His only break was taking a few days off when travelling to England on work, to spend time with his son.

is particular about Often swipes his finger along the floor of the metro train as well as the platform to check for dirt.



Land Lord

Because despite the economic downturn, he's still one of the largest private landholders in the country, with 751 million square feet of real estate waiting to be built up.

Because he may have lost \$27.2 billion since March, but his fortune is still valued at \$7.8 billion, down from \$30 billion last year.

how's the loss affecting him?
"It's only paper," he says.

recession index Hasn't bought anything new to wear in the past four years because he realised he hadn't worn 60 per cent of the clothes in his wardrobe.

big mantra Prosperity is the time for austerity. Don't wait for adversity.

favourite haunts Harry's Bar and Groucho Club, London, and Breeze, a 52nd floor rooftop Bangkok restaurant.

K.P. SINGH
77, Businessman 10

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BANDEEP SINGH

Cruise Control

Because he will always have an opinion and people who matter will always lend an ear, especially now that he has a bigger pulpit in the Rajya Sabha.

Because the Bajaj Group revenues are revving up to cross Rs 20,000 crore this year and Bajaj Auto, with over Rs 7,000 crore in cash reserves, is as good as a bank.

Because finally there is peace in Hamara Bajaj—he not only settled the Bajaj family dispute but also put in place a succession plan, with a business each for sons Rajiv and Sanjeev.

Because Bajaj Auto owns 30 per cent of Austrian performance bike maker KTM.

uncanny knack To be at the right place at the right time. On September 16, the day after Wall Street collapsed, he was attending the NYSE advisory board meeting.

little known fact Bajaj has been a debt-free company for 30 years.



RAHUL BAJAJ
70, Industrialist 36

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HEMANT CHAWLA